

MICAH VANDEGRIFT

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Human-Centered Operations Leader

People-centered service delivery leader with a passion for building, coaching, and leading teams to deliver exceptional customer and operational outcomes. Brings a proven record of strengthening customer experience, accelerating onboarding timelines, and elevating cross-functional team performance through hands-on people leadership and trust-based collaboration across Product, Sales, UX, and Operations. Has led initiatives that improved onboarding by 35–45%, increased engagement by 25–75%, and advanced user satisfaction by empowering contributors and aligning teams around clear goals. Combines systems thinking, empathy, and strategic collaboration to help teams thrive in complex research, government, and technology environments — and is seeking a next role that continues to center people leadership and team development.

CORE SKILLS

Team Development & Coaching | Cross-Functional Leadership | User Experience Strategy | Knowledge Management | Operational Leadership | Service Delivery Management | Customer Success Strategy | AI-Enhanced Workflows | Customer Experience Transformation | Platform & SaaS Enablement | Strategic Account Management | Escalation Management | Process Optimization | KPI Development & Performance Metrics | Change Management | Technical Project Management | Creative Collaboration | Cross-functional alignment | Human-Centered Operational Design | Relationship Building & Stakeholder Engagement | Process Improvement & Optimization | Strategic collaboration | Evidence-Driven Decision-Making | Public Speaking | Jira | Salesforce | Asana | Confluence | Notion | Miro

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

DIGITAL SCIENCE, Remote

Aug 2024 – Nov 2025

Digital Science is an AI-focused technology company providing innovative solutions to complex challenges faced by researchers, universities, funders, industry and publishers.

Client Configuration & Support Lead

- Led cross-functional teams to deliver an AI prompt repository, a product reconfiguration, and a platform prototype redesign to strengthen customer delivery and team alignment.
- Implemented AI-enhanced onboarding workflows that reduced onboarding time by 35%, improving customer clarity and accelerating time-to-value.
- Strengthened operational excellence through prioritization frameworks, accountability systems, and continuous improvement practices.
- Drove customer re-engagement strategies using data-informed insights to boost adoption and long-term satisfaction.
- Served as escalation lead, building alignment across Product, Sales, UX, and Operations to deliver integrated customer solutions and improve stakeholder coordination.

NATIONAL INSTITUTES OF HEALTH

Mar 2022 – Aug 2024

National Institutes of Health: primary agency of the United States government responsible for biomedical and public health research. Contract Role.

Team Lead, User Experience / Senior Strategist

- Managed and developed a team of six employees to analyze customer pain points and design solutions that increased customer satisfaction by 5% and reduced onboarding time by 45%.

- Oversaw program execution to ensure alignment with quality and strategic objectives.
- Accelerated critical program milestones by 2.5 years and exceeded performance targets by 20% through operational refinement and evidence-driven decision-making.
- Built knowledge-management strategies and customer experience structures that enabled scalable service delivery and improved cross-team coordination.

NC STATE UNIVERSITY, Raleigh, NC

May 2018 – Mar 2022

Associate Director

- Led a \$414K multisite digital innovation program that earned two Webby Award nominations and produced a 25% increase in engagement.
- Mentored contributors and coordinated a team of 3-5 high-performing employees, graduate students, and interns to deliver innovative digital services and strengthen multi-site collaboration.
- Founded a science-focused technology accelerator that launched 50% of projects within one year and expanded institutional innovation capacity.

FLORIDA STATE UNIVERSITY, Tallahassee, FL

Dec 2011 – Apr 2018

Director, Jun 2016 – Apr 2018

- Founded and scaled a new innovation-focused service portfolio
- Hired, mentored, and managed a high-functioning team of seven employees.
- Led performance oversight, workload planning, and professional development to sustain team effectiveness and innovation momentum.
- Strengthened operational impact and institutional visibility by securing \$3M in NIH grant funding and \$35,000 in seed funding.

Program & Product Manager, Dec 2011 – May 2016

- Led customer-facing platform launches and lifecycle management initiatives, driving improved usability and sustained adoption.
- Increased user engagement by 75% through data-informed service enhancements and strategic program execution.
- Coordinated cross-functional collaboration to align evolving customer needs with scalable product delivery models

EDUCATION

Master (M.S.) of Library & Information Science, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

Master of Arts (M.A.), American Studies, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

Bachelor of Arts (B.A.), Humanities, Florida State University, Tallahassee, FL

DISTINCTIONS

Best AI Hack, Digital Science Retreat (2025)

Fulbright Scholar, Netherlands & Denmark (2018)

Fred L. Standley Librarian of the Year (2015)